

Business Travel Policy

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Document status: Detailed fictional enterprise reference policy for RAG development and testing.

Important: This document is a reference policy, not an actual policy issued by a specific company. Replace rates, approval authorities, tax treatment and local requirements with your organization's approved rules before production use.

Purpose

Establishes rules for planning, authorizing, booking, conducting and documenting business travel.

1. Scope and Definitions

Applies to employees, contractors and other workers who incur authorized business travel expenses.

1.1 Business Travel

Business travel means travel away from an employee's normal work location for an approved business purpose.

1.2 Policy Principles

- Expenses must have a legitimate business purpose.
- Employees must use reasonable and economical options.
- Expenses must be submitted accurately and on time.
- Duplicate reimbursement is prohibited.
- Falsified or altered receipts may result in disciplinary action.

2. Roles and Responsibilities

Employee

- Obtain required approval.
- Use approved suppliers where available.
- Retain receipts and supporting evidence.
- Submit complete and accurate claims.
- Repay unused advances or personal amounts.

Manager

- Confirm business purpose and necessity.
- Review reasonableness and documentation.
- Approve exceptions only within delegated authority.
- Escalate suspected fraud.

Finance

- Maintain controls and audit procedures.
- Validate claims.
- Process approved reimbursement.
- Maintain records under retention requirements.

3. Travel Authorization

Travel should be authorized before non-refundable bookings are made. Requests should state traveler, destination, dates, business purpose, estimated cost and required approvals.

Emergency Travel

Where prior approval is impractical, obtain manager confirmation as soon as reasonably possible and document the reason.

Changes and Cancellations

Cancel or change bookings promptly. Refunds, credits and unused tickets remain company property unless Finance authorizes otherwise.

4. Booking Standards

- Use the designated travel agency or booking platform where available.
- Select a reasonable fare considering total journey time and flexibility.
- Purchase ancillary services only when necessary.
- Personal preferences must not create additional company cost.

5. Air Travel

Cabin Class

Economy is the default for domestic and short-haul international travel. Premium Economy may be permitted for qualifying long-haul journeys. Business Class requires eligibility or explicit approval.

Baggage

One standard checked bag is reimbursable where necessary. Excess baggage is reimbursable when required for business materials or extended travel and supported by an explanation.

Seat Selection

Standard seat selection is reimbursable when required for operational reasons. Premium seating requires eligibility or approval.

6. Rail and Intercity Travel

Rail should be used where practical and cost-effective. Standard class is the default unless an eligible class is approved. Overnight sleeper accommodation may be permitted for long journeys.

7. Personal Travel Extensions

Employees may combine business and personal travel if permitted and if company cost does not increase. Incremental personal airfare, hotel, meals and transportation are the employee's responsibility.

8. Travel Advances

Advances may be issued where authorized. They must be reconciled against actual expenses within the claim deadline. Unused balances must be returned promptly.

9. Safety and Duty of Care

- Follow company travel advisories and security instructions.
- Maintain current emergency contact information.
- Obtain additional approval where required for elevated-risk destinations.
- Use company-arranged travel assistance or insurance where provided.

10. Reference Approval Matrix

Action	Employee	Manager	Finance/Senior
Standard domestic travel	Request	Approve	As required
International travel	Request	Approve	As required
Business Class outside eligibility	Request + justification	Recommend	Approve
Policy exception	Request + justification	Recommend	Approve under delegation

11. FAQs

Can I book directly with an airline?

Only where the approved process permits direct booking or the approved channel is unavailable.

Can I extend a trip for personal reasons?

Yes if permitted, but incremental personal costs must be paid by the employee.

What if my flight is cancelled?

Use the approved travel provider where possible and retain evidence of rebooking, cancellation or refund.